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# Copy the Rich - Principles You Can Adapt

What can be copied from large fortunes, what requires scale and access, and what should never be imitated.

## **MATRIX REPROGRAMMED - DETAILED WEALTH GUIDE**

Reader outcome: Choose accessible versions of proven wealth principles while rejecting scale-dependent or destructive tactics.

Best for: A reader seeking practical ownership and capital-allocation lessons without celebrity worship or reckless concentration.

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**Educational information only. No personalised financial, investment, legal or tax advice. No guaranteed outcomes.**

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## 1. Create wealth versus preserve wealth

Large fortunes are often created through concentrated ownership in one enterprise and preserved through diversification, liquidity and governance.

A beginner should not copy the mature portfolio of someone whose original wealth came from business equity.

Separate the engine that created wealth from the system that protects it.

The accessible lesson is disciplined ownership and reinvestment, not blind concentration.

## 2. Principle 1 - Retain ownership

Equity can scale beyond wages because the owner participates in enterprise value and future cash flow.

Accessible versions include a small business, diversified shares, profit participation or intellectual property.

Ownership also carries downside, dilution, liability and illiquidity.

Do not confuse being self-employed with owning a transferable system.

## 3. Principle 2 - Build distribution

Brands, networks, marketplaces, sales systems and recurring customer access often matter as much as the product.

Accessible version: own a customer list with permission, referral network, local partnerships or searchable expertise.

Do not depend entirely on one platform that can change access or fees.

Measure conversion, retention and customer concentration.

## 4. Principle 3 - Reinvest at high returns

Successful owners reinvest where the expected return on incremental capital remains attractive and measurable.

Accessible version: reinvest in skills, proven marketing, equipment with contracted demand or diversified assets.

Stop reinvesting when growth consumes cash without improving contribution or durable value.

Record the return hypothesis before spending.

## 5. Principle 4 - Use leverage selectively

Wealthy owners may borrow against durable assets or predictable cash flows, but leverage magnifies error and can force sales.

Accessible version: use debt only when repayment remains safe under conservative stress.

Never copy complex leverage without understanding covenants, variable rates, guarantees and liquidity.

Borrowing to speculate can turn a temporary decline into permanent loss.

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## 6. Principle 5 - Control taxes and fees legally

Large fortunes use specialists, long holding periods, eligible wrappers and deliberate transaction timing.

Accessible version: keep records, claim lawful expenses, use appropriate accounts and minimise unnecessary turnover.

Tax reduction is not a reason to buy a poor asset or create an uneconomic company. Avoid promoters selling secrecy, artificial losses or guaranteed tax outcomes.

## 7. Principle 6 - Maintain liquidity

Liquidity prevents forced sales, supports negotiation and creates optionality during stress.

Accessible version: emergency cash, business runway, sinking funds and unused borrowing capacity that is not required for survival.

Too little liquidity creates fragility; too much unplanned cash may lose purchasing power.

Define the purpose and time horizon of each cash reserve.

## 8. Principle 7 - Buy expertise and governance

Professionals and boards can reduce blind spots when their incentives, competence and scope are clear.

Accessible version: pay for a focused legal, tax, accounting or technical review at decision points.

Verify adviser regulation, conflicts, compensation and deliverables.

Keep decision rights and understand the advice rather than outsourcing responsibility.

## 9. Principle 8 - Concentrate effort, diversify survival

Career and business effort may be focused while personal survival assets remain diversified and liquid.

Do not allow employer equity, home, pension and future income to depend on one company without recognising concentration.

Set explicit concentration limits as wealth grows.

Diversify after the value-creation engine is proven, not by launching many weak projects at once.

## 10. What not to copy

Do not copy political access, opaque related-party transactions, aggressive tax schemes or regulatory arbitrage.

Do not copy illiquid private deals you cannot evaluate or exit.

Do not copy billionaire consumption before building the underlying cash engine.

Do not copy public holdings without knowing purchase price, hedges, tax position, liabilities or total portfolio.

Do not assume wealth proves ethics, skill in every field or future investment

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## 10. What not to copy (continued)

success.

## 11. Personal adaptation plan

- ☐ Choose one ownership asset to build or acquire.
- ☐ Choose one distribution asset to strengthen.
- ☐ Define the reinvestment rule.
- ☐ Define the liquidity minimum.
- ☐ Define the maximum leverage.
- ☐ Define the concentration limit.
- ☐ Name the next professional review.
- ☐ Write one tactic you will not copy.

## 12. How to use this guide

Purpose: Choose accessible versions of proven wealth principles while rejecting scale-dependent or destructive tactics.

Best reader: A reader seeking practical ownership and capital-allocation lessons without celebrity worship or reckless concentration.

Read the guide once without taking action. On the second pass, complete the checklists and write down the evidence supporting each decision.

Replace every example number with your own verified amount, date, fee, tax treatment, contract term or source document.

Do not treat a checklist tick as proof. Keep copies of the underlying statements, quotations, filings, contracts and calculations.

For major decisions, use this guide to prepare better questions for a regulated adviser, accountant, lawyer, lender or insurer.

## 13. Evidence standard

Tier 1: law, regulator, tax authority, court, audited accounts, official product document or signed contract.

Tier 2: recognised institutional research that states its methodology, date and limitations.

Tier 3: reputable reporting used to identify questions, not to replace primary evidence.

Tier 4: marketing, social posts, testimonials, screenshots and anonymous claims. Treat these as unverified leads.

Write the source date beside every changing figure. A correct figure without a date can become misleading.

Separate facts, estimates, assumptions and scenarios. Never allow a scenario to be presented as a forecast or guarantee.

A company, fund, adviser, trust, structure, transaction or association is not proof of misconduct.

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## 14. Decision record worksheet

- ☐ State the decision in one sentence.
- ☐ State the desired result and deadline.
- ☐ List the three strongest pieces of supporting evidence.
- ☐ List the three strongest reasons the decision may fail.
- ☐ Record the maximum acceptable loss of money, time and flexibility.
- ☐ Record the smallest reversible test.
- ☐ Name the person responsible for checking legal, tax or regulatory consequences.
- ☐ Set the next review date and the evidence that would cause you to stop.

## 15. Professional advice triggers

Seek regulated investment advice when product suitability, risk capacity, pensions, insurance or a large portfolio decision is unclear.

Seek tax advice before changing residence, extracting company cash, transferring assets, using trusts, gifting substantial sums or entering cross-border arrangements.

Seek legal advice before signing guarantees, shareholder agreements, acquisition contracts, complex leases, loan security or beneficiary arrangements.

Seek accounting advice when turnover, VAT, payroll, inventory, multiple activities or company-group transactions become material.

Use a defined written question. Paying for broad reassurance without documents or calculations rarely produces a useful answer.

## 16. Subject focus map

Use the following subject anchors as named checkpoints. For each checkpoint, record the fact, source, date, assumption, decision and next review date.

CREATE VS PRESERVE: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

OWNERSHIP: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

LIQUIDITY: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

DO NOT COPY: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

Do not mark a checkpoint complete because an action was taken. Mark it complete only when the result and supporting evidence have been recorded.

Where a checkpoint depends on another person, institution, platform or contract, record that dependency and a fallback route.

Rank checkpoints by potential harm if ignored, not by how interesting or easy they appear.

At the end of each review, choose one checkpoint to advance and one risk to reduce before adding a new objective.

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## 17. Worked decision case

Write a real decision from your own situation at the top of a blank page. Examples include changing work, launching an offer, choosing an account, buying an asset, restructuring a business or rejecting a proposal.

Baseline: state the current cash, income, liabilities, commitments, ownership, legal position and time available. Use documents rather than memory where possible.

Desired result: describe the measurable outcome, deadline and reason. Remove vague language such as more, better, passive, safe or guaranteed.

Options: include the proposed action, a smaller reversible test, a diversified alternative, delaying the action and doing nothing.

Evidence: attach at least three independent sources. Identify which evidence is official, contractual, audited, estimated, promotional or missing.

Economics: show setup cost, recurring cost, cash timing, fees, tax reserve, downside loss, opportunity cost and the point at which the decision becomes worthwhile.

Risk: identify concentration, liquidity, legal, operational, fraud, health, relationship and behavioural risks. Name the risk that could create irreversible harm.

Professional review: write the exact question that requires an accountant, lawyer, regulated adviser, lender, insurer or technical specialist.

Decision: state proceed, test, delay or reject. Record the maximum commitment and the evidence required before any further commitment.

Review: set a dated checkpoint. Write the result that would confirm the decision, the result that would require adjustment and the result that would trigger an immediate stop.

## 18. 90-day implementation workbook

Week 1 - Establish the baseline. Reconcile the relevant accounts, contracts, statements, fees, tax records, responsibilities and deadlines.

Week 2 - Define the result. Choose one measurable outcome and remove actions that do not directly support it or protect an essential risk.

Week 3 - Gather primary evidence. Use official registers, filings, signed terms, current quotations and dated institutional data.

Week 4 - Compare alternatives. Include a lower-cost option, a lower-risk option, a reversible test and the option to wait.

Week 5 - Model the economics. Build downside, base and upside cases while treating every uncertain input as an assumption.

Week 6 - Verify identity and authority. Confirm who owns, controls, advises, holds money, signs contracts and bears liability.

Week 7 - Run the smallest useful test. Limit money, time and legal commitment while collecting evidence about real demand or performance.

Week 8 - Reconcile actual results. Compare promised, expected and actual cost, time, cash flow, quality, risk and customer or counterparty behaviour.

Week 9 - Repair the constraint. Improve the single factor currently limiting income, retention, safety, liquidity, delivery or evidence quality.

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## 18. 90-day implementation workbook (continued)

Week 10 - Install controls. Add calendar reminders, approval limits, account separation, written procedures, backups and review ownership.

Week 11 - Decide whether to scale. Increase commitment only when the test produced measurable value and the downside remains affordable.

Week 12 - Complete the evidence file. Store the decision record, sources, calculations, contracts, results, lessons and next review date.

Day 90 - Write a one-page conclusion: what was established, what remains uncertain, what changed, what will continue and what will stop.

## 19. Review, escalation and stop rules

Review monthly when the decision affects recurring cash, debt, customer commitments, investment contributions or essential protection.

Review immediately after a material legal change, tax notice, contract change, security incident, missed payment, large loss, health event or relationship change.

Escalate to a qualified professional when the facts cross jurisdictions, involve regulated products, create personal guarantees, affect beneficiaries or cannot be reversed cheaply.

Pause when required documents are missing, identities cannot be independently verified, costs are unclear or the counterparty resists reasonable due diligence.

Stop when the action requires deception, undeclared income, false invoices, hidden beneficial ownership, unaffordable leverage or essential-living money.

Stop when actual cash use, delivery time or loss exceeds the written limit.

Stop when the central evidence is corrected, withdrawn, contradicted by a stronger source or no longer current.

Do not move a stop limit merely because money, pride or time has already been committed. Sunk cost is not evidence that continuing is rational.

Record every exception to the plan, who approved it and why. Repeated exceptions indicate the plan or control is not working.

A stopped action can still be a successful decision when it prevents a larger loss and preserves the ability to act later.

## 20. Evidence and legal boundary

This is educational information, not personalised financial, investment, legal, accounting or tax advice.

Investments can fall in value. Businesses can fail. Debt, leverage, illiquidity, tax and legal obligations can create losses greater than the expected benefit.

Rules and thresholds change. Verify the current official position on the date of action.

Never use false invoices, hidden ownership, undeclared income, sham transactions, misleading applications or borrowed essential-living money.

No return, saving, valuation, tax outcome or business result is guaranteed.



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## 21. Official research routes

1. SEC EDGAR - <https://www.sec.gov/edgar/search/>
2. Entreprendre.Service-Public.fr - Business creation - <https://entreprendre.service-public.fr/>
3. Bpifrance Creation - <https://bpifrance-creation.fr/>
4. AMF - Verify an authorisation - <https://www.amf-france.org/fr/espace-epargnants/proteger-son-epargne/faire-les-verifications>
5. impots.gouv.fr - Assurance-vie and PEA - <https://www.impots.gouv.fr/particulier/lassurance-vie-et-le-pea-0>